

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3314

Name

Marissa Maroni

Emailmaroni.marissa@gmail.com**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Philadelphia, PA, United States

Nationality

American

When did or will you finish your PhD?

Expected Spring 2025

University Education

Doctor of Philosophy | Neuroscience | University of Pennsylvania | Expected graduation Spring 2025

Bachelor of Science | Bridgewater State University | Biology | August 2015 – May 2019

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

Science educators have an important role in conveying complex topics, guiding students towards conceptual themes, and building excitement for the natural world. I got my first taste of how rewarding this can be by working as a summer camp instructor as a teenager. Here, I taught children about woodland animals and watched eyes light up with excitement as they began hopping around like the rabbits they were learning about. Like the research I do as a neuroscientist, teaching gives me the opportunity to learn something. I constantly test new methods of dispensing information that includes trialing labs with active participation, such as activating students' motor neurons in small groups to demonstrate how electric signals travel in the brain. I

progress as a teacher after every class and fine-tune how I meet my goals of guiding, supporting, and exciting students. I am applying to Science Corps to develop as an educator, use my passion for science to foster excitement in international communities, and expand my perspective and reach as an educator to a global scale. As a Science Corps fellow, I will build off my foundation as an educator to create student-centered class structure, diversify instruction, and build excitement about science.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

Throughout my PhD, I have actively sought teaching opportunities that supplement my thesis work. Each of these experiences provided a foundational skillset that I will utilize while working as a Science Corps fellow. The most impactful experience has been co-directing a high school level neuroscience summer course through the Upward Bound program for the past two years. As co-director, I designed courses, managed teachers and volunteers, edited classroom materials, and led a summer long neuroscience course about neuron signaling, sensory systems, neuroscience technologies, and brain development. In this position, I gained experience generating and administering course content about complex neuroscience topics and breaking them down to a digestible level for a high school audience. The goal of this course was to show students that they can be actively involved in the scientific process. Thus, I prioritized lessons to be student-centered, scaffolded for younger minds, and most importantly, fun. My numerous teaching experiences throughout graduate school, including my role with Upward Bound, have challenged me as an educator to always consider the question: "What will excite students about this content?" Creating fun, impactful, and digestible course content is a skillset I plan to utilize and hone as a Science Corps fellow.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In two years, I imagine myself conducting research as a postdoctoral fellow in a small model system neuroscience lab and teaching courses at a nearby college. Small model systems are a great introduction to novel genetic experiments for undergraduates, are scalable to allow students to increase experimental load as research progresses, and are cost-effective, a key consideration for primarily undergraduate institutions. I hope to use my research in the classes I teach to introduce students to the tools that scientists use to test hypotheses.

In ten years, I aim to be a tenure-track faculty member at a primarily undergraduate institution. I believe that the undergraduate level is a critical period for early career scientists where students, when given the opportunity, can thrive and find excitement in STEM fields. I hope to collaborate with nearby community colleges to reach a wider breadth of students and expand their research opportunities. Using my passion for creatively designing lessons, I aim to create lectures and labs that are fun while also building foundational skills in science research. The Science Corps fellowship would provide a key step in achieving these goals by supplying the unique opportunity to educate full-time at the global scale.

CV/Resume[Curriculum-Vitae-Marissa-Maroni.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

Empty

[Science Corps](#)